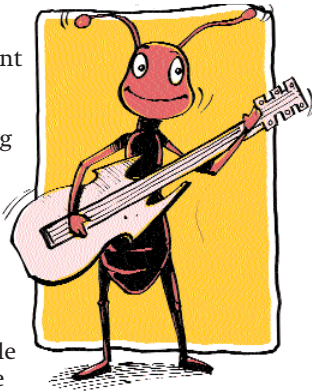


Quantum Rock

Dustin Carr, grad student in physics, and Harold Craighead, professor of applied and engineering physics, got together to create one of the world's smallest mechanical devices—a six-string guitar. The nano-guitar is about 10 micrometers long, or about the size of a single human cell. Each of the six strings measures 50 nanometres—as wide as 100 atoms placed together. When plucked by an atomic force microscope, the strings would resonate at inaudible frequencies. The device was constructed using electron-beam lithography which consists of scanning a beam of electrons across a surface covered with a thin film, called a resist. The electrons produce a chemical change in this resist, which allows the surface to be patterned. But who will play it?

www.news.cornell.edu/Chronicle/97/8.14.97/nanoguitar.html



Jenny Phone Home

Jenny L Chowdhury, a B.S. in Electrical Engineering and a member of the IEEE, has created what we consider the present-day version of the pocket-less pants: The Cell Atlantic CellBooth. It's a wearable phone booth you can carry on your back. The concept goes as follows: when you receive a call, you unzip and literally wear the booth to create an illusion of private space. Why, you ask? We'll let Jenny explain: "We talk on cell phones everywhere we go, disregarding issues of privacy (and also those of courtesy). People often don't care if others hear their end of the conversation... What would happen if we were forced to stand still while we spoke on the phone? As I grappled with these issues of privacy, personal space and nostalgia for a 'simpler time,' the idea for portable phone booth was born... What emerged was a wearable/portable phone booth and subsequently a piece of performance art that calls the attention of New Yorkers to the changes in human behaviour due to the ubiquitous use of cell phones." Preach it sister!

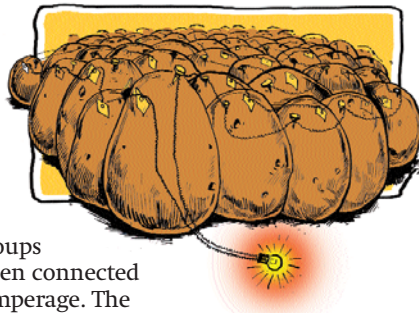
<http://jennylc.com/cellbooth/>



A Salt And Battery

Amos Latteier, called the "Best Fake Professor in Portland," and a self-confessed lover of pigeons, woke up one day to build a battery out of 500 pounds of potatoes. Each potato generates about 0.5 volts and 0.2 milliamperes, he explains. Amos connected groups of potatoes in series to increase voltage, and then connected these groups together in parallel to increase amperage. The entire 500-pound battery generated around 5 volts and 4 milliamperes. He then hauled the battery onto a truck and drove it around town, powering a sound system off it. "Don't eat potatoes after using them for a battery," Amos advises.

<http://latteier.com/potato/>



"Do These Make Me Look Stupid, Number One?"

In our efforts to look as stupid-cool as Geordi La Forge of *Star Trek: The Next Generation*, we have often resigned ourselves to wearing a hair-band across our eyes—if only we'd learned of this wondrous machine earlier, oh, the shame it would have spared!

This implement wraps around your eyes, and if you survive the heckling crowds, it allows you to watch DVDs as you walk (or run, if the crowd is particularly nasty).

The movie is delivered through a tiny 320 x 480 LCD monitor embedded in the right eyepiece. The glasses also feature an inbuilt pair of ear-bud headphones. The video display is placed on the upper right of the glasses, giving you the ability to view the immediate surroundings while watching a DVD. Not recommended for one-eyed pirates!

www.livedigitally.com/?p=663



Cubicle Missile Crisis

Mortals! The USB slot's true purpose on our planet has been revealed—and a bloody purpose it is too! The USB Missile Launcher, straight from the desk of George Bush lets you bomb your neighbouring colleague if he refuses to pass the pen. With the aid of the mouse, the launcher pans 180 degrees and tilts up to 45 degrees; a click and you will launch a harmless foam projectile... Complete with sound effects.

www.latestbuy.com.au/usb_missile_launcher.html



By Ahmed Shaikh